



Aaron Gogna

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Summary

I have spent 14 years at the intersection of financial services strategy and digital transformation – advising RBC, CIBC, Scotiabank, TD, and BMO on the investment decisions and governance frameworks that determine whether transformation programs compound or quietly collapse. Now deploying enterprise AI platforms that Fortune 500 organizations actually run their businesses on - most recently for Kraft Heinz that activated 1,200 daily users, generated \$37M in value, and compressed concept-to-market timelines from 8 weeks to 8 days.

I know what it takes to get an AI program funded, governed, adopted, and defended at the board level. And I know what it takes to make it stick after the pilot ends. That is the hardest part of this work. It is also where I am strongest.

Relevant Experience

Apply Digital
Director, AI Transformation
2024 – Present
Toronto, ON, Canada

Apply Digital is a high-growth product, experience and AI consultancy that partners with Fortune 500 financial services organizations and global enterprises to lead large-scale AI and digital transformation programs, drive portfolio planning and prioritization, and deliver sustained enterprise value through AI.

- Led end-to-end AI and digital transformation programs in high-ambiguity environments, taking strategic initiatives from ideation and hypothesis development through validation, design, build, pilot deployment, and scaling, while concurrently driving the people, process, and technology changes required to operationalize AI solutions and deliver measurable enterprise business impact.
- Owned AI transformation portfolio strategy for multiple Fortune 500 clients simultaneously, leading investment prioritization, funding governance, and program sequencing to focus resources on the highest-impact initiatives and ensure AI programs moved from strategy to production rather than stalling between pilot and scale.
- Built the AI transformation practice from zero inside Apply Digital, establishing the portfolio governance frameworks, value realization methodologies, investment prioritization protocols, and delivery standards that define how the practice operates, driving \$1M+ in revenue impact within the first 6 months.
- Designed and owned value realization systems for enterprise AI programs, building the ROI models, performance measurement architectures, and outcome tracking frameworks that proved AI was delivering business impact. Example: partnered with Kraft Heinz to define and launch TasteMaker, an enterprise AI platform now used by 1,200+ users, compressing concept-to-market timelines from 8 weeks to 8 days and unlocking \$37M in measurable value YTD in 2025.



- Served as the primary trusted advisor to CTOs, CMOs, CPOs, and CFOs on AI strategy, producing board-ready investment cases, executive governance updates, portfolio performance narratives, and decision frameworks that gave senior leaders the analytical foundation to fund, defend, and scale AI programs at the enterprise level.
- Drove cross-functional alignment across product, technology, finance, marketing, and operations, building consensus on AI transformation priorities, managing competing stakeholder interests, and ensuring strategic direction translated into coordinated execution and measurable outcomes across complex, matrixed organizations.

Simon-Kucher

Director, Financial Services and Head of Customer Experience Practice, North America

2015 – 2024

New York, NY, USA

Simon-Kucher is a top-tier global management consultancy (2,000+ employees) and the world's leading authority on commercial strategy, pricing, and transformation — the firm that Fortune 500 financial services companies, major Canadian banks, and fintechs call when strategy, transformation, and value realization are the highest-stakes problems on the table.

- Owned end-to-end strategy and governance for a portfolio of digital transformation and AI programs across North American financial services, fintech, and technology clients, leading investment prioritization, funding decisions, and program sequencing to ensure the highest-impact initiatives were resourced, governed, and delivered against measurable business outcomes.
- Served as Head of Customer Experience for North America, redesigning digital ecosystems for Canada's largest financial institutions across the full customer lifecycle - from acquisition and onboarding through product discovery, cross-sell, lifecycle engagement, and retention - translating AI and digital capability into measurable improvements in customer adoption and revenue performance.
- Built the North American AI and Digital Transformation practice from zero to a \$5M+ P&L, ten-person team, and six consecutive quarters of double-digit growth, establishing the portfolio management frameworks, governance protocols, value realization methodologies, and delivery standards that defined how the practice operated and scaled.
- Acted as the primary trusted advisor to CTOs, CMOs, CPOs, and CFOs at RBC, CIBC, Scotiabank, TD, and BMO, translating AI and digital transformation complexity into board-ready governance updates, investment business cases, and executive decision frameworks that shaped multi-year technology investment decisions at the Board and executive committee level.
- Built and owned the value realization system for AI and digital transformation programs, designing the financial models, ROI frameworks, and performance measurement architectures that gave executive sponsors the analytical confidence to defend large-scale AI investments — incorporating market sizing, cohort economics, scenario simulations, and margin sensitivity on programs with hundreds of millions in revenue at stake.
- Applied behavioral economics and primary research to AI adoption design, translating deep insights into how financial services organizations actually change behavior into adoption architectures, change management frameworks, and enablement programs that moved transformation from executive mandate to operational reality. Example: designed an AI adoption program for a major Canadian financial institution using choice architecture and the Zeigarnik effect, lifting products-per-customer by 200%+ in pilot cohorts.



- Led and developed a high-performing AI transformation team, establishing operating rhythms, performance standards, and career development frameworks while personally building the executive-facing governance materials, strategic narratives, and board presentations that kept senior stakeholders aligned and AI programs moving through the organization.

Qapital

Embedded Digital Transformation Leader and Client Partner

2016 – 2022

New York, NY, USA

Qapital is a B2C fintech and Simon-Kucher client serving 2M+ users, known for applying behavioral economics to automate financial habits across saving, budgeting, investing, and debt management.

- Embedded as the strategic growth partner to Qapital's co-CEOs over six years, identifying where the business should go next, shaping long-term vision with senior leadership, and translating strategy into actionable growth initiatives that drove the platform from early-stage fintech to a 2M+ user, \$2.8B-deposit business recognized as Google Play's "Most Innovative App" and Apple's "Best App for Savings."
- Led end-to-end digital growth transformation across the full customer lifecycle, owning strategy and execution from first-touch acquisition through product discovery, onboarding, activation, cross-sell mechanics, lifecycle engagement, and long-term retention, ensuring every stage of the funnel compounded into durable member growth.
- Analyzed consumer, market, and competitor trends to inform company strategy and growth priorities, developing deep analytical insights into how everyday Americans make financial decisions and translating those insights into growth strategies and product recommendations that drove durable acquisition, activation, engagement, and retention at consumer fintech scale.
- Built and owned complex financial models and analytical frameworks incorporating market sizing, cohort economics, elasticity analyses, scenario simulations, revenue forecasting, and margin sensitivity, using rigorous data-driven decision-making to prioritize the highest-impact growth initiatives and guide executive investment decisions in real time.
- Designed and owned the pricing, packaging, and subscription economics that underpinned Qapital's commercial growth engine, architecting three-tier subscription tiers, feature gating, value proposition mapping, upgrade mechanics, and retention systems that delivered 82%+ contribution margins, 12.6x LTV/CAC, 10-month payback, and a trajectory to projected \$238M in annual subscription revenue.
- Combined behavioral economics expertise and primary consumer research to translate willingness-to-pay thresholds, choice architecture, anchoring effects, loss aversion structures, and commitment devices into growth strategies, onboarding architectures, and lifecycle engagement systems that changed everyday consumer financial behavior at scale, driving a 28% conversion rate and 4M+ goals created.
- Drove cross-functional growth execution without direct authority, influencing and aligning Product, Marketing, Analytics, Finance, and Operations on strategic priorities, holding the full organization accountable to growth targets, and ensuring strategy translated into real execution with measurable outcomes quarter over quarter.
- Personally built the executive narratives, growth business cases, and investment recommendations that shaped Qapital's multi-year strategic direction, communicating complex analytical findings and consumer insights to senior leadership in clear, decision-ready formats that drove alignment and action.



- Delivered durable growth outcomes that rival the best consumer fintech businesses in the world: 2M+ users, \$2.8B in deposits, 98%+ monthly retention post-onboarding, 70% one-year retention at nearly 2x the industry average, 93rd-percentile NPS of 57 versus 32 industry average, 4.8-star App Store rating across 80K+ reviews, and a projected \$238M subscription revenue run rate, demonstrating the ability to turn strategic vision into compounding, defensible business outcomes at consumer scale.

University of Toronto
Research Lead, Behavioral Economics
2012 – 2015
Toronto, ON, Canada

- Conducted quantitative and qualitative research on consumer behavior, decision-making, behavioral economics, incentives, and choice architecture, building the foundation for later work in executive transformation, adoption design, customer experience, and AI-enabled behavior change.
- Translated complex behavioral data into structured insights, analytical models, research narratives, and presentations for senior academic stakeholders.
- Developed rigorous understanding of how people adopt new behaviors, respond to incentives, navigate tradeoffs, and make decisions under uncertainty - expertise later applied to enterprise transformation, product adoption, executive enablement, and embedded experience design.

Skills & Core Competencies

AI and digital transformation strategy and leadership, portfolio planning and prioritization for large-scale AI programs, executive governance and board-level communication, value realization framework design and ROI measurement, AI investment discipline and funding governance, trusted C-suite advisory and stakeholder alignment, financial modeling and business case development, program management and cross-functional execution, people management and high-performing team development, financial services and fintech expertise, market and competitive intelligence, organizational change management and adoption, and enterprise governance and regulatory environment navigation.

Select Client Experience

A versatile background leading AI and digital transformation programs and strategy engagements for market leaders across financial services, fintech, technology, consumer goods, retail, and entertainment, including RBC, CIBC, Scotiabank, TD Bank, BMO, Mastercard, Capital One, Chase, ADP, Allstate, Finastra, Qapital, Kraft Heinz, Canadian Tire, NBA, Cloudflare, Lululemon, Arc'teryx, Moderna, Cadre, and 30+ more.